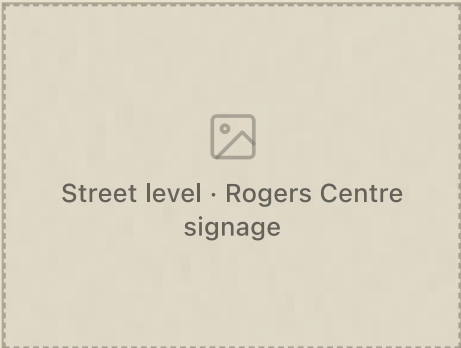
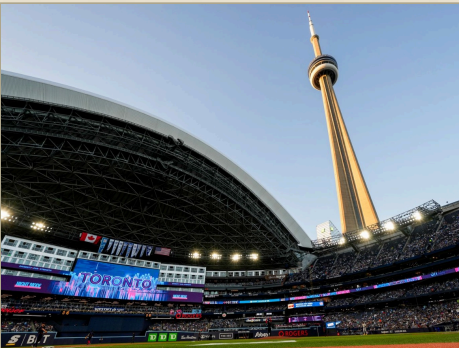


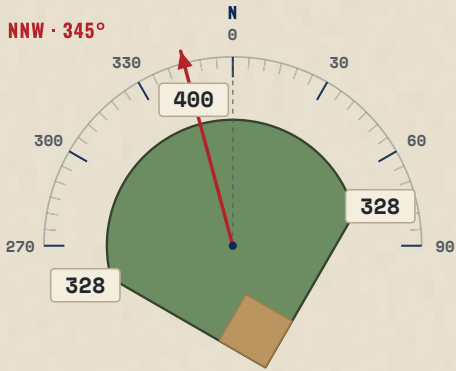
STADIUM SECTION



STADIUM FACTS

OPENED	1989
YEARS ACTIVE	1989–Present
CONSTRUCTION START	Oct 3, 1986
OPENING DAY	Jun 3, 1989
CAPACITY	41,500 (originally 50,516)
SURFACE	Artificial - AstroTurf 3D Xtreme with dirt infield
ARCHITECT	Rod Robbie and Michael Allen <i>Structural design by Adjleian Allen Rubeli</i>

FIELD DIMENSIONS & ORIENTATION



STADIUM CONTEXT

Rogers Centre belongs to a different dream of modern baseball than the retro parks that soon followed it. Opened in 1989, it was a high-tech multipurpose stadium built for a downtown Toronto setting, with a retractable roof that made weather control part of the spectacle. Exhibition Stadium had been the predecessor, but the new building promised something more ambitious: baseball, football, concerts, civic events, and climate management inside one enormous piece of urban machinery.

Its downtown placement gave the stadium a public visibility that many multipurpose parks lacked. Rather than occupy a remote sports complex, it sat in the central city, where scale and engineering could become part of Toronto's late twentieth-century image. The roof was not a minor feature; it was the building's premise. In a northern city, a retractable dome offered certainty without fully surrendering the idea of open-air baseball. That bargain made sense for its moment, when cities were still willing to imagine the future of sport as technologically expansive, multipurpose, and enclosed when necessary.

TYPE	Multipurpose retractable-roof stadium adapted increasingly toward baseball
STYLE	Late multipurpose high-tech retractable-dome stadium, now retrofitted toward baseball-specific use
NAME HISTORY	SkyDome (1989–2005) Rogers Centre (2005–Present)
PRECEDED BY	Exhibition Stadium (1977–1989)
RENOVATIONS	Major 2023–2025 phased renovation of outfield districts, seating bowl, clubhouses, premium areas, video boards, and fan amenities

AT A GLANCE

STATUS	ACTIVE
ERA	MULTIPURPOSE SHARED USE
ROOF	RETRACTABLE
LOCATION	DOWNTOWN
ELEVATION	250 FT

But the same qualities that made the building impressive also made it difficult to keep aligned with baseball's next phase. Rogers Centre was not born from the retro-classic turn toward intimacy, asymmetry, and neighborhood texture. It was big, flexible, and engineered at a scale that treated baseball as one use among several. Over time, that flexibility became less valuable than baseball-specific experience. The major 2023–2025 renovations to outfield districts, seating bowl, clubhouses, premium areas, video boards, and fan amenities reveal the shift: the building has had to be edited toward baseball rather than merely maintained.

That makes Rogers Centre especially useful in the stadium timeline. It is not simply the last gasp of the shared use multipurpose idea or an early retractable-roof experiment. It is a surviving high-tech stadium being retrofitted into a more specialized ballpark culture. Its story is not replacement, at least not yet, but conversion: a building from one future of baseball being steadily adapted to fit another.

VISIT SECTION

NORTHERN MIDWEST TRIP · VISIT 37 OF 42

FEATURED VISIT · THURSDAY, JUL 20, 2023

Group Visit FEATURED	1:07 PM EDT FIRST PITCH	43,196 ATTENDANCE	2:53 DURATION	9 INNINGS
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WEATHER

77°
CLEAR

8 mph SSE
WIND

68%
HUMIDITY

SAN DIEGO PADRES

AT

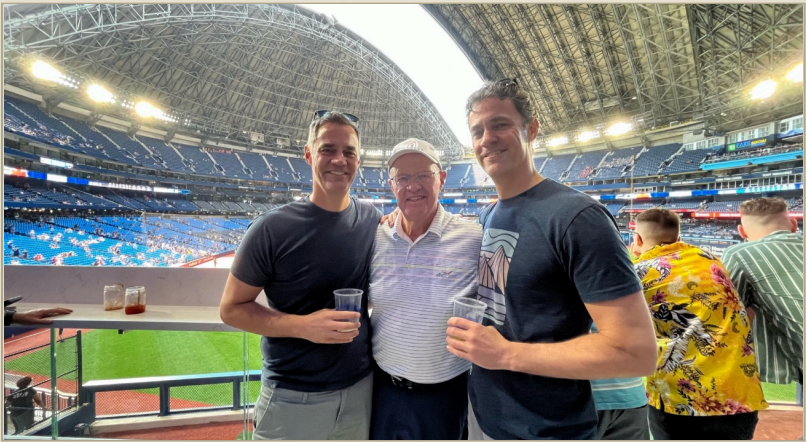
TORONTO BLUE JAYS

BLUE JAYS 4, PADRES 0

	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	R	H	E
SD	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	6	0
TOR	0	1	0	0	0	0	1	2	x	4	9	1

STARTERS
Blake Snell (*SD*)
vs. **Chris Bassitt** (*TOR*)

DECISION
W Chris Bassitt
L Blake Snell



DESIGN & CONSTRUCTION

FACADE	Concrete-and-steel multipurpose shell with steel/PVC retractable-roof panels and selective glazed edges
ORIGINAL COST	\$470 million <i>\$1.26 billion adjusted</i>
FINANCING	Public-private partnership led by Ontario, Canada, and Toronto public entities with private corporate participation; later privately acquired by Rogers
COORDINATES	43.6414° N, 79.3892° W
ADDRESS	1 Blue Jays Way, Toronto, ON M5V 1J1, Canada